1 **field** [fi:ld] *n.* — поле
A large piece of open ground where plants are grown.
→ The farmer walked across the wide field.

2 **branch** [brɑ:ntʃ] *n.* — ветка
One of the parts of a tree that grows out from it.
→ The bird sat on a low branch and waited.

3 **plant** [plɑ:nt] *v.* — сажать
To put a seed or a young tree into the ground so that it grows.
→ We plant flowers in the garden every spring.

4 **seed** [si:d] *n.* — семя, семечко
The small hard part of a plant that a new plant grows from.
→ She pushed the seeds into the wet ground.

5 **leaf** [li:f] *n. (leaves)* — лист
The flat green part that grows on a tree or a plant.
→ Every leaf on the tree turned yellow.

6 **dig** [dɪg] *v. (dug)* — копать
To make a hole in the ground, or take something out of it.
→ The dog dug a hole under the wall.

7 **beak** [bi:k] *n.* — клюв
The hard pointed mouth of a bird.
→ The bird carried a piece of bread in its beak.

8 **root** [ru:t] *n.* — корень
The part of a plant that grows under the ground.
→ A carrot is the root of the plant.

9 **sweet** [swi:t] *adj.* — сладкий
Tasting like sugar or honey.
→ These small apples are very sweet.

10 **climb** [klaɪm] *v.* — взбираться, расти вверх
To go up something, or to grow upwards.
→ The boy climbed the tree to get his ball.

11 **deal** [di:l] *n.* — сделка, договор
An agreement between two people about what each one will do.
→ They made a deal: he cooks and she washes.

Useful phrases from the story

make a deal — договориться, заключить сделку
They made a deal before they started the work.

make a mistake — сделать ошибку
I made a mistake and took the wrong bag.

find out — узнать, выяснить
He found out later that the answer was wrong.

The Bear Who Chose First

A bear lived beside a wide **field**. He told every animal that the field was his. He never worked in it. But he was big, so nobody said no to him. Nobody but a crow.

"You cannot eat a field," the crow said from a low **branch**. "Somebody must **plant** something first. And you do not know how."

The bear thought about that for a long time. "Then we will work together," he said. "You will do the work. We will take half each. But I am bigger, so I must choose my half first."

"Very well," the crow answered. "Let us **make a deal**. You may choose every spring. You will choose before I put the **seed** into the ground."

The bear knew one thing about plants. Good things grow up, towards the sun. "Everything above the ground is mine," he said. "You may keep the dirty part under it."

All summer, green **leaves** grew across the field. The bear sat beside it and felt proud of himself.

Then the cold days came. The animals gathered to watch. The bear pulled up his half and took home a small mountain of leaves. They were hard and dry. They tasted of nothing at all. Then the crow **dug** into the soft ground with her feet and her **beak**. She pulled out the **roots**: long orange carrots, **sweet** and heavy and full of food.

That was how the bear **found out** where a carrot keeps its dinner.

"You **made a mistake**," the crow said kindly. "The best part was below."

The bear did not sleep well that winter. In spring he came back with his mind already made up.

"This year everything below the ground is mine," he said. "Every root. You can have the green part on top."

"Are you sure?" asked the crow. "You should think a little longer. You might want to choose again."

"I have decided," said the bear.

So the crow planted apple trees. That summer they **climbed** up over the bear's head. At the end of summer every tree above him was heavy and red. The whole field smelled of apples.

The bear came with his big hands and dug all day. Under the trees he found nothing but hard, dry wood. Above him the crow sat in the leaves and ate.

"You could have asked me," she said. "I would have told you. It would have cost you nothing."

The bear still owns the field. But now, when somebody says he can choose first, he sits down. He looks at the sky for a while. He looks at the ground for a while. And he asks what is going to grow.

